

Keiko Yamashita

Senior Backend Engineer | Fintech & AI Systems

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CORE SKILLS

Python, Go, PostgreSQL, Redis, AWS (EC2, Lambda, RDS, SQS), gRPC, REST APIs, LLM Integration, Agent Orchestration, Kafka, Docker, Terraform, Payment Processing, Machine Learning Ops

EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineer, Payment Systems | Vertex Financial Technologies | Seattle, WA

March 2024 – Present

- Architected and shipped real-time transaction dispute resolution agent serving 50K+ daily users, integrating GPT-4 with internal risk models via API layer
- Agent processes merchant appeals, retrieves transaction context from PostgreSQL, queries external fraud databases, and generates settlement recommendations with 87% acceptance rate
- Built asynchronous processing pipeline on AWS Lambda and SQS to handle 10K concurrent dispute cases without service degradation
- Collaborated with compliance and merchant success teams to define agent decision boundaries and logging requirements for regulatory audits

Backend Engineer, Infrastructure | Cascade Data Labs | Portland, OR

July 2021 – February 2024

- Designed and maintained distributed payment routing system handling \$2B+ annual transaction volume across 12 payment processors
- Developed gRPC services in Go for real-time ledger consistency, reducing settlement reconciliation time from 4 hours to 12 minutes
- Deployed multi-region failover architecture on AWS using Terraform, achieving 99.99% uptime SLA across production environments
- Led migration of legacy batch processing to Kafka-based event streaming, enabling real-time fraud signal propagation

Software Engineer | Helix Systems | Portland, OR

June 2018 – June 2021

- Built core payment gateway APIs and managed PostgreSQL schema scaling for growing merchant base (10K to 100K customers)
- Implemented Redis caching layer reducing API response latency by 65% during peak transaction windows
- Owned deployment pipeline and containerization of microservices using Docker and Kubernetes

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science | University of Washington | 2018